[life is beta]

MONTHLY REVIEW · LIOR POZIN · AUGUST 2026

The two platforms that were not in the room

August across all five channels, with LinkedIn and X added to the offsite picture, and where the 500K and 100K targets actually stand.

August 2026 | 5,300,365 views | ~203K followers | Month 2 of Q3

FOLLOWERS, FIRST

August added 10,904 followers, and two platforms produced 20% of them

PLATFORM	JULY NET	AUGUST NET	TOTAL ON AUG 31
Instagram	+24,354	+8,976	104,659
LinkedIn	+821	+1,373	12,980
X	~+175	+845	~1,330
Facebook	+14,400	-290	~84,000
TikTok	not pulled	not pulled	22,300 on Sep 8
Total measured	**+39,750**	**+10,904**	**~202,969**

Follower acquisition fell 73% against July, and both of the platforms that grew are the two that were missing from the offsite. LinkedIn had its best month on record and X had its best month by a factor of four, while Facebook turned negative and Instagram gave back two thirds of a month that one photo post had carried.

The total still clears the quarter. Roughly **203,000 followers on four measured platforms** beats the ~202K September target a month early, before TikTok's 22,300 is counted.

THE CORRECTION

August was not 4.8 million. It was 5.3 million.

The offsite deck read Instagram, Facebook and TikTok. LinkedIn and X were left out, and they turned out to be the two fastest growing lines in the portfolio. Adding them changes the total and it changes the conclusion.

144,796

LINKEDIN IMPRESSIONS

+102% over July. 207% of the September target.

324,235

X IMPRESSIONS

+247% over July.

+2,218

FOLLOWERS THE ROOM NEVER COUNTED

1,373 on LinkedIn, 845 on X. Both records.

> Everything the offsite concluded still holds. The picture is simply less bad, and the evidence for the artifact thesis is now stronger, because two more platforms produced it independently.

THE MONTH

One platform fell. Every other line rose.

PLATFORM	JULY	AUGUST	CHANGE	FOLLOWERS AUG 31
Instagram	4,100,000	3,331,989	-18.7%	104,659
Facebook	3,181,303	107,426	-96.6%	~84,000
TikTok	858,333	1,391,919	+62.2%	not pulled
X	93,400	324,235	+247%	~1,330
LinkedIn	71,776	144,796	+102%	12,980
Total	**8,304,812**	**5,300,365**	-36.2%	**~202,969**

Facebook lost 3,073,877 views. The whole portfolio lost 3,004,447. Everything outside Facebook grew by 69,430 while carrying a 41% jump in Instagram output that bought no extra reach.

LINKEDIN

Four months of a flat follower line, then August

From April to July, LinkedIn impressions moved 6x and new followers never left a narrow band. May bought 292,705 impressions and produced 1,100 followers. That was the strongest argument we had that reach does not buy followers on this platform.

MONTH	IMPRESSIONS	NET FOLLOWERS	FOLLOWERS PER 1K IMP	TOTAL
April	49,353	+922	18.7	8,677
May	292,705	+1,100	3.8	9,777
June	51,839	+1,009	19.5	10,786
July	71,776	+821	11.4	11,607
August	**144,796**	**+1,373**	**9.5**	**12,980**

August ran at half of May's reach and produced **57% more followers**. It is the first month in five to break the band, and one post carried it: the ungated 47-slide exit deck of 25 August, 70,922 impressions and 2,906 engagements, the best post this account has ever had by engagement. The same artifact behind a comment gate had done 55 impressions.

69,295

MEMBERS REACHED

+180% over July

3.23%

ENGAGEMENT RATE

4,675 engagements, up 137%

30%

FOUNDERS AND CEOS BY TITLE

Unchanged from July. The ICP held through a viral month.

X

3.5x the reach, and the followers came from a different post

X had its best month by every metric. 324,235 impressions on 23 posts is 14,097 per post against July's 3,890. Bookmarks, the signal we weight triple, grew eight-fold to 3,663.

DAY	WHAT RAN	IMPRESSIONS	SHARE OF MONTH	NEW FOLLOWS	SHARE OF MONTH
Aug 19-20	"Someone on Reddit just LEAKED..."	226,670	70%	51	6%
Aug 15-17	"The kid nobody would have bet on"	62,842	19%	748	86%

The viral post got 3,185 likes and 84 profile clicks. The personal-timeline thread got 154 likes and **1,179 profile clicks**, and 489 of those turned into follows in one day. Same account, same week, opposite outcomes.

THE RULE AUGUST PRODUCED

Reach and followers are two different buys

POST	PLATFORM	IMPRESSIONS	FOLLOWERS	PER 1K IMP
Reddit leak	X	226,670	51	0.2
10 startups list	Instagram	332,000	3,200	9.6
Exit deck, ungated	LinkedIn	69,539	~590	8.5
Kid nobody would bet on	X	62,842	748	11.9

Volume and virality move impressions. First-party artifacts and personal-timeline stories move followers. Instagram said it in July with the age-14 post, and in August three platforms said it independently in the same four weeks.

THE TARGETS

Where 500K and 100K actually stand on 31 August

Instagram to 500,000

20.9% **104,659**

Gap of 395,341. Trailing-3 pace +12,690 a month.

LinkedIn to 100,000

13.0% **12,980**

Gap of 87,020. Trailing-3 pace +1,068 a month.

	INSTAGRAM 500K	LINKEDIN 100K
Followers on Aug 31	104,659	12,980
Gap	395,341	87,020
August net	+8,976	+1,373
Trailing-3 average	+12,690	+1,068
Arrival at trailing-3 pace	31 months, ~Apr 2029	82 months, ~2033
Pace needed for 12 months	+32,945/mo, 2.6x	+7,252/mo, 6.8x
Pace needed for 24 months	+16,472/mo, 1.3x	+3,626/mo, 3.4x

Multiples are against the trailing-3 pace, which is the number that survives a single viral month.

THE PACE, READ HONESTLY

On pace for the quarter. Off pace for the goal.

Those are two different questions and August answers them differently. The Q3 numbers land. The two follower targets do not, on any reading of the current rate.

First, the average flatters us. Instagram's last three months are +4,740, +24,354, +8,976. That is a 5x swing, so the trailing-3 average of 12,690 is one exceptional month carried by one post, sitting on top of two ordinary ones. The median month, 8,976, is the number we actually own. Both are shown below and the truth sits between them.

	INSTAGRAM 500K	LINKEDIN 100K
Average month	+12,690	+1,068
Median month	+8,976	+1,009
Lands at the average	31 months, Apr 2029	82 months, Feb 2033
Lands at the median	44 months, May 2030	86 months, Nov 2033
% of the pace a 24-month landing needs	55-77%	28-29%
% of the pace a 12-month landing needs	27-39%	14-15%

Instagram: the ceiling is fine, the variance is the problem

A 24-month landing needs 16,472 a month. July did 148% of that. August did 54%. So the target does not need a bigger month, it needs every second month to look like July instead of one in three. Nothing about the pace says 500K is out of reach; it says the growth is event-driven and nobody has put the events on a calendar.

LinkedIn: the pace is a fifth of what the goal needs

A 24-month landing needs 3,626 a month. The best month this account has ever had produced 1,373. Five months of data sit between 821 and 1,373, and four of the five predate the only mechanism that moved the line. So the pace does not say "push harder", it says the current machine tops out at roughly a third of the requirement.

WHAT THE PACE IS ACTUALLY MADE OF

Growth is priced in artifacts, so the pace is a publishing schedule

Every month that beat its own average was carried by the same thing. Volume never did it.

WHAT PRODUCED THE MONTH	PLATFORM	FOLLOWERS
10-startups list, comment-gated	Instagram	3,200
Age-14 childhood photo post, July	Instagram	14,000-15,000
Exit deck, comment-gated	Instagram	1,400
Exit deck, ungated	LinkedIn	~590
Personal-timeline thread	X	748
161 pieces of ordinary output	Instagram	55% of a below-average month

So the pace converts into a quota, and the quota is the plan.

TO LAND IN	LINKEDIN NEEDS PER MONTH	BASELINE	ARTIFACT POSTS PER MONTH	VERDICT
24 months	+3,626	~1,050	5, all different	A weekly signature series. Achievable.
12 months	+7,252	~1,050	11, all different	No archive holds eleven a month. Paid question.

All different is the binding word. The same asset rerun on Instagram went 3,200, then 267, then 207, so it decays 94% by the fourth outing. The pace scales with new documents, and with nothing else.

THE COST OF A SLOW QUARTER

Waiting until January makes both targets harder, and one of them noticeably

IF THE SERIES STARTS	INSTAGRAM NEEDS	LINKEDIN NEEDS	LINKEDIN ARTIFACTS PER MONTH
September 2026	+16,472/mo	+3,626/mo	5
January 2027	+17,972/mo	+4,141/mo	6

Four months of drift at the current rate adds 9% to the Instagram requirement and 14% to LinkedIn's, which is one more artifact post every month for the rest of the run. The arrears compound, so the cheapest month to start is this one.

> The conclusion in one line: Instagram is on a pace that reaches 500K if the good month stops being rare, and LinkedIn is on a pace that reaches 100K in 2033 unless the artifact series becomes weekly. Both fixes are the same fix, and it is a supply of documents rather than a supply of posts.

Q3 STATUS

Followers are ahead. Views are behind, and it is one line.

KR	SEPTEMBER TARGET	AUGUST ACTUAL	STATUS
Total views per month	7,000,000	5,300,365	76%
Total followers	~202,000	~202,969	done, TikTok not counted
Instagram views	2,600,000	3,331,989	128%
Instagram followers	95,000	104,659	110%
Facebook views	4,000,000	107,426	3%
Facebook followers	96,000	~84,000	88%
LinkedIn impressions	70,000	144,796	207%
LinkedIn followers	13,500	12,980	96%, needs +520
TikTok views	350,000	1,391,919	398%
X impressions	40,000	324,235	810%

Facebook is 4 million of the 7 million target and delivers 0.11 million. Strip it out and the rest of the portfolio is running above 8 million against a 3 million commitment. The quarterly view miss is a Facebook question, not a content question.

SEPTEMBER

Three things this data asks for

01 **Name ten documents and ship one a week.** The LinkedIn 100K math turns on five artifact posts a month, and each one has to be a different asset. Two artifacts have carried two months and one of them is finished.

02 **Stop paying for Instagram volume.** 161 pieces bought 42% less reach per piece than 114 did, and profile visits stayed flat. The follower line came from five posts. Move the hours from output to artifacts.

03 **Settle Facebook with one number.** Post count for August against July, and views per post for each. If views per post fell 95% it is distribution. If the post count fell 95% it is the Instagram connection. Nobody should commit budget before that number exists.

Sources: LinkedIn AggregateAnalytics export 1-31 Aug 2026 · X Account Analytics daily export 1-31 Aug 2026 · Metricool per-post backfill 2026-09-08 · Instagram, Facebook and TikTok figures from the offsite pack of 2026-09-02. Raw data and full workings in 0-output/monthly-summary-2026-08/data-collected.md